

UNWOMEN STUDY GUIDE



Combating Violence Against Women in the Digital Age

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1. Letter from the Secretary General

Dear Delegates,

From the very beginning, MOSTRAMUN was never meant to be simply another conference. We wanted it to become a place filled with ambition, curiosity, and genuine human connection. A place where diplomacy feels sincere, where discussions carry meaning, and where people feel encouraged to share their voices without fear of being inexperienced or imperfect.

Because MUN has never been only about resolutions or policy debates.

It is about discovering confidence in moments where your voice shakes but you choose to speak anyway. It is about listening to perspectives different from your own and leaving the room with a broader understanding of both the world and yourself. Sometimes, the most meaningful parts of conferences are not found in formal sessions at all, but in the conversations between the people you meet, the ideas you carry with you, and the realization that growth often begins outside your comfort zone.

As Secretary-General of Mostramun'26, I would like to sincerely thank every delegate, advisor, chair, and member of our organization team whose dedication made this conference possible. MOSTRAMUN'26 is shaped by the people within it, and your presence is what gives this conference its spirit.

It is truly an honor to welcome you all to MOSTRAMUN'26, and I hope this conference becomes an experience that inspires, challenges, and stays with you long after it comes to an end.

Sincerely,
Melek Mimar
Secretary-General of MOSTRAMUN'26

2. Letter from the Under Secretary General

Dear Delegates,

It is my utmost pleasure to welcome you to the UNWOMEN Committee. Throughout this conference, you will have the opportunity to debate one of the most pressing global issues of our time and collaborate in search of effective and innovative solutions.

As delegates, I encourage you to engage actively in debate, think critically, and uphold the principles of diplomacy and respect. This study guide has been prepared to provide you with a foundation for your research and to help you better understand the agenda at hand. As you can see from the topics of the study guide, as your chairboard we aim to address current issues that scandalizes international security and directly human rights while mostly targeting innocent women and children. We expect you to focus on both our general agenda and the specific issue of Epstein Files.

Scincerely,
Defne Güzelsoy
Under Secretary General

3. Letter from the Academic Assistant

Dear Delegates,

I , Deniz Yıldırım, will be serving as the Academic Assistant of the UNWOMEN committee in this conference , which i sincerely welcome you all into. This study guide and committee has been prepared through vigorous efforts in order to ensure that you are well versed in the topics related to our agenda item which will be discussed in detail during our sessions. It also aims to help you if you decide to do further research regarding the agenda item. I urge you to utilize this resource to its full extent and absorb every information it means to provide to you. I sincerely hope our sessions together will be entertaining , productive and smooth-sailing.

Best regards,
Deniz Yıldırım
Academic Assistant

4. Introduction to the Committee: UNWOMEN

United Nations Entity for Gender Equality and the Empowerment of Women (UNWOMEN) is a UN body that aims to advance women's rights , gender equality and the empowerment of all women and girls , globally in all spaces.



UNWOMEN ; as the lead United Nations(UN) entity for gender equality and women's rights; through their partnerships with governments , non governmental organizations(NGOs) , women's movements , the private sector and other UN bodies makes lasting changes in spaces where gender equality and women's rights are being oppressed, unrecognized or ignored.

Leadership , economic empowerment , freedom from violence , humanitarian action for peace and security are mainly the fields that UNWOMEN makes advancements in.

Over the years , UN has led the establishment of multiple agreements between states concerning the safety of women and the advancement of women's rights , most notably Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action and the Convention on the Elimination of All Discrimination Against Women(CEDAW) are some of the agreements which have had long lasting positive impacts and are supported internationally. It should be stated that UNWOMEN follows these agreements and helps improve these agreements through supporting amendments to certain treaties or calling for meetings to redefine and discuss certain parts of such agreements.

UNWOMEN supports intergovernmental bodies in their formulation of global policies , helps member states to implement standards for gender equality and women's empowerment while providing technical and financial support if necessary and leads UN systems which aim to mitigate gender inequality , gender-based discrimination and abuse by regular monitoring and coordination. The Economic and Social Council(ECOSOC) , the Commission on the Status of Women and the United Nations Human Rights Council(UNHRC) are some of the intergovernmental bodies which UNWOMEN provides support to.

UNWOMEN has a critical role in the battle against gender based violence against women in the digital age. With its resources , partnerships and programmes delegates are expected to form solutions to prevent and mitigate the problems which allow instances of violence against women to occur.

5. Introduction to the Agenda Item:Violence Against Women in the Digital Age

In the past , with the lack of or with limited access to electronic devices and the Internet, approaches taken while combatting violence against women were more focused on preventing violence against women outside of the virtual world, in physical places such as workplaces and in social constructs such as families and traditions that degrade women through the means of improving judicial systems , raising accountability , shaping educational systems and spreading public awareness...

While those steps and actions remain to be the cornerstone of all pro-gender equality and anti-Violence Against Women(VAW) movements with the immense technological progression that came with the Digital Age , in the current state of the world , the problem has become more complex than ever. Technology and the Internet provided people all around with possibilities which they could only dream of in the past such as the accessibility to basically any sort of information , however along with the benefits brought by the development came thousands of new ways for abusers of women to torment their victims , find new ones and get away with all of them. Whether it's through social media platforms and chat websites which aren't monitored correctly , usage of information illegally obtained to blackmail individuals , legal gaps or another method which results in the victim's psychological , physical or mental damage , in the digital age it has become much harder to identify and prevent such instances.

New solutions and methods must utilize technological and technical means if necessary to combat the concerning increasing number of incidents that fall under the category of VAW.

5.1 Defining Gender Based Violence(GBV)

Gender Based Violence(GBV for short) can be defined as violence directed at someone because of that person's gender or any violence which negatively affects people of a particular gender. Gender Based Violence is usually directed at female individuals.

Although women are the primary victims of gender based violence, it doesn't only harm the individuals who the GBV is directed at but the families , communities , cultures and children in these spaces where the incident occurs.

There are multiple forms of Gender Based Violence , each of them being devastatingly damaging to the victim and the society. Physical violence which is physical damage being dealt to the victim through punching , beating etc. ; sexual violence where action carrying sexual intent are made without the victims consent , via blackmailing or other methods ; emotional or psychological violence which includes verbal harrasment that is insulting and degrading to the victim , also including isolating someone from their friends and family and domestic violence which is any sort of gender based violence committed by a family member directed at a family member , are some of the commonly seen yet very damaging forms of Gender Based Violence.

These forms of gender based violence can be done through the Internet and digital spaces , or it can be used as a tool for more effectiveness when it comes to types such as physical violence. The GBVs done through digital environments fall under the umbrella term , "online violence".

5.2 The Expansion of Digital Spaces and Social Media

Social media and Internet usage has surged over recent years , with all types of users from all across the world holding all sorts of intents now being able to use such platforms to communicate , see and

observe people. Very clearly , some parts of the internet and social media platforms are prone to be taken advantage of by abusers and harassers of women.

Data gaps , weak moderation systems , lack of extensive legislation and lack of accountability are some of the factors which allow online violence to continue increasing and continue harming women in various ways.

In digital spaces ; through deepfake technology , artificial intelligence , weakly moderated communication platforms , dataleaks ; people with harmful intent can very easily commit acts of psychological violence and social violence. With the rate that social media platforms are expanding, thousands of new users joining these platforms weekly, moderation and investigation of cases of Gender Based Violence becomes increasingly more difficult. Besides that , in some instances social media platforms were used as places to share and find private information and pictures regarding individuals , who were mostly women. Such instances are critical breaches of personal privacy and if ignored and not punished could escalate into worse incidents.

Especially in the last 5 years , intelligent programs called “Artificial Intelligence” have had significant interest in them and technology involving these programs have progressed rapidly and significantly. It has come to a point that using certain AI programs a person could generate a video or image of someone doing anything , anywhere and anytime. These programs , even though they may be made with good intentions and intended to be used for educational purposes , nonetheless can be used for sinister purposes as well. In its current state , as a part of a digital environment filled to the brim with people who commit such acts of violence , such programs can be used in a way that puts others in danger. Accountability and traceability measures definitely need to be established .

5.3 The Role of UN and International Organizations

The United Nations , through its bodies such as ECOSOC and UNWOMEN along with conventions and agreements UN has led and established such as CEDAW; in the near past and the present have been fairly supportive of women’s rights and gender equality as a whole.

The United Nations ,as they have had before, have a critical role in the safety of women in the Digital Age as well. Through its resources and international power , it can fulfill its role and protect women and women's rights in digital environments.

The United Nations , through UNWOMEN and its other bodies , takes action and has taken action regarding this matter.

The UN holds a critically important role when it comes to shaping laws and policies on this matter. With its close ties to governments and international bodies , through platforms like the Commission on the Status of Women and the UN General Assembly, the UN can make a positive impact on international policy. The Global Digital Compact is also an important framework regarding our topic , as it is also a framework led by the UN and a framework that covers governance of artificial intelligence and digital co-operation.

It should be noted that accountability , traceability and co-operation with technological companies which hold data of social media platforms where GBV and VAW instances occur are topics which need to be addressed when it comes to policy talk since these factors are what effects the sustainability and the effectiveness of future solutions and attempts at tackling the issue.

UNWOMEN supports and as it is a key part of its mission should support feminist movements urging to take action or taking action about women's safety and Gender Based Violence on digital environments. Feminist movements have hugely positive impacts on the public awareness of these issues faced by women in the Digital Age. UNWOMEN can support these movements by strengthening the voices of the movements and providing necessary tools and knowledge for these groups.

Public awareness can also be raised through means such as campaigns and educational reforms. UNWOMEN and the UN also have a critical role when it comes to public awareness being raised about the topic.

A critical problem which is present in many cases of online violence against women is data and knowledge gaps. The UN similarly has a crucial role in this matter. Developing standardized methodologies and closing knowledge gaps are some of the things which UNWOMEN can do.

Lastly; UN being a highly recognized intergovernmental body and having multiple partnerships with both the private sector and Non Governmental Organizations(NGOs) have the potential to collaborate with critical parties for effectiveness and the establishment of long term solutions

The International Telecommunication Union(ITU) is another UN body which is important in this topic. Cybersecurity , artificial intelligence , safety of children and gender equality in online spaces all concern the International Telecommunication Union. ITU also focuses on education of the youth regarding informative technologies , which affect our agenda item because a part of the substantial increase of GBVs is tied to miseducation and the lack of education regarding the responsible and ethical usage of electronic devices and the Internet.

It is worth noting that ITU has partnered and collaborated with global alliances and NGOs aiming to make the Internet a secure environment for women , in the past.

Cyber harassment and technology facilitated gender based violence(TFGBV) can be done at a concerningly large scale at times from very distant locations and different countries. On instances in which online abuse is committed internationally and when technical assistance and education is needed , The International Criminal Police Organization(INTERPOL) and United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime(UNODC) are significant actors which have the potential to make a positive impact.

United Nations Development Programme(UNDP) is another UN programme which concerns the increasing number of TFGBV cases committed against women in recent years.

They have financially and verbally supported movements and NGOs tackling online abuse. UNDP most notably have implemented and supported the eMonitor+ initiative aimed at mapping sensitive harmful content against women on the Internet and flagging hate speech across platforms. Currently, this program is active in 4 countries in the world ; Lebanon , Libya , Peru and Tunisia. It should be said that eMonitor+ is an AI powered program.

The United Nations and its bodies are not the only organizations and institutions which have a role in making digital spaces safe for women all across the world. Other intergovernmental bodies and NGOs also have a crucial position in the conflict against online violence.

NGOs such as the International Women's Media Foundation(IWMF) which have technical capacity are significantly important in this context and have crucial roles. Since they have technical and media capacity , with co-operation between them and other bodies like UNWOMEN, lasting change can be delivered and current efforts can be amplified.

IWMF specifically is an effective NGO on this matterç They do; digital security training , documentation and reporting of abuse , emergency assistance , legal support and advocacy for those who have become victims of TFGBV , especially cases which also fall under VAW. Another example of a media-based feminist NGO is World Pulse.

Other feminist and non-feminist NGOs such as Women for Women's Human Rights(WWHR) and Global Fund for Women have a role that makes it a responsibility for them to provide limited financial assistance and support to programs which tackle the online abuse issue and increase public awareness through means possible.

Organizations such as the European Union(EU) and the African Union(AU) which are intergovernmental and have collaborated with the UN multiple times in the past have valuable tasks as well. They are important platforms for regional co-operation and policy shaping. EU and AU for example have taken action and joined alliances for mitigating online abuse and hate speech against women in order to make digital environments a safe place for them. It could be said that their approaches and decisions kind of make an example for their bodies.

6. Technology Facilitated Gender Based Violence

Gender Based Violence(GBV for short) can be defined as violence directed at someone because of that person's gender or any violence which negatively affects people of a particular gender. Gender Based Violence is usually directed at female individuals.

Technology Facilitated Gender Based Violence(TFGBV) is when technological tools , digital platforms or the internet is used to commit the acts of violence and abuse , or when they are used to amplify the intensity of the abuse.

Technology Facilitated Gender Based Violence , although they are the same principally with Gender based violence , due to the endless possibilities technology brings onto the table ; requires newer , more technical , stronger and extensive solutions , movements and actions to combat.

This section of the study guide focuses on the in depth analysis of the types of Technology Facilitated Gender Based Violence and their specific negative effects on women , the society and communities.

6.1 Online Harassment and Cyberbullying

Cyberbullying , by definition, is the practice of bullying a person by sending messages or posting social media content of an intimidating, mocking, or threatening nature. Countless women all across the world from all nations which have access to the internet are more prone to experience cyberbullying and online harassment compared to male individuals from the same societies and communities which have similar habits using the Internet.

Studies show that 38 percent of women with unrestricted access to the Internet have experienced some sort of online harassment or cyberbullying , whether through social media platforms or other kinds of communication based applications and websites. According to these studies , 80 percent of women with unrestricted access to the Internet have observed and seen fellow women experience forms of cyberbullying and digital harassment.

According to information verified by the United Nations Development Programme ; about 60 percent of women residing in Arabic States , over 50 percent in Eastern Europe and Asia and 28 percent in Sub-Saharan Africa have experienced or reported some sort of cyberbullying and online harassment. Intense cyberbullying can cause countless mental problems in people , such as depression , harmful habits and low self-esteem. While on the surface level , it may seem to some as this issue isn't something that the United Nations should be worried about since it is personal more than anything. However , taking into account how horrible the negative impact can be on people and the sheer amount of women experiencing these issues that view is irresponsible and flat out wrong.

Cyberbullying of this kind usually occurs in social media platforms , especially those with unadvanced monitoring systems and lack of regard for the increasing number of incidents.

The lack of regulation and monitoring , the disguise of digital anonymity , inexistence of punishment(in some places) and the belief that it could be gotten away with are some of the reasons despite all actions taken cyberbullying against women still continue to surge and exist.

It stands clear that policy changes , of both states and private companies which run and manage these digital platforms where online harassment occurs , are important for long-lasting solutions for cyberbullying.

6.2 Online Exploitation

First , let's define the term "exploitation". Exploitation means the action or fact of treating someone unfairly in order to benefit from their work or the action of making use of and benefiting from resources. In online platforms , through various ways and because of certain conditions of victims , exploitation of women can be done.

By exploitation of women , we mean an exploiter with sinister intent using certain things and taking advantage of vulnerable situations to exploit a female individual. Whether its through blackmailing or other methods , it is a severe issue which many women face in the digital era.

The most common form of exploitation of women is through blackmailing an individual with threatening to use or release sensitive information or imagery about the individual which would put the individual in an undesirable position which forces the victim to comply with any demand of the person threatening to release the information. To threaten someone with the release of sensitive imagery of them is referred to as Imagery Based Sexual Abuse(IBSA).

Through methods such as doxxing in the digital age, sensitive information is much more accessible by those who mean to use it in a bad way than ever before. It has reached a very concerning amount over the last years.

Besides doxxing , there have been several instances where generative artificial intelligence technology was utilized for such sinister purposes. AI is a technology that only has had recent developments which allowed it to generate realistic footage. However , even though it hasn't been much long since the public had free access to such tools, the emergence of such incidents is truly frightening.

Whether it's through doxxing or generative artificial intelligence , this is a significant safety risk and action most definitely needs to be taken. Policies handling AI should be shaped or reconsidered taking into account these risks that come alongside it. It should be discussed what part large-scale technology companies should have in this.

6.3 Gendered Hate Speech

Hate speech means any form of communication , such as a post or a text , which is meant to target people with a specific quality , such as being a woman or being a person of color, to hurt or offend the people who hate speech targets.

Gendered hate speech , sadly , is one of the most common forms of hate speech spotted easily in the present and throughout history. In the past , gendered hate speech , especially against females , was common since women's rights weren't as advanced as it is today and due to this societal belief that men were superior to women, gendered hate speech against women was normalized. In the present , it isn't as common as it was decades ago , however it continues to emerge constantly even though steps to ensure women's rights have been taken by most countries , keeping in mind gendered hate speech is still not a rare thing in states which took steps against it.

The current surge in gendered hate speech is closely tied to the progression of the Digital Age. With the digital age , came along thousands of platforms meant for self-expression. While in its roots the right to express one's opinions and thoughts is a necessity , oftentimes the line between self expression and hate speech is crossed. In the physical world , when words are uttered they are heard and where the sound came from can be understood. In a digital space , it can be much more complicated than that.

A reason why hate speech cannot be countered effectively today and what compels people that have desires to speak hatred is how easy it can be to avoid punishment if you said hate speech on digital platforms. Because of weak moderation systems and knowledge gaps, hate speakers can get away with their speech. The lack of reaction only encourages more to commit hate speech.

Hate speech mentally harms and psychologically affects the victims of it. It divides communities and creates tension. Hate speech being left unreacted on platforms which children are also present sets a bad example and makes the viewer believe it is a normal thing to do without consequences.

Measures such as stronger moderation systems and harsher consequences might be necessary for effective solutions. Either way, at the current rate hate speech is left unchecked online, in the near future it will start being normalized again which will end up badly for women all across the world.

6.4 Impact on Survivors and Humanitarian Dimension

Technology Facilitated Gender Based Violence can leave permanent scars on survivors and communities which were targeted. It may harm its victims in various ways, psychologically, physically or socially. TFGBV often violates the right to privacy and right to express oneself and results in severe mental scars in whoever experiences it. In every perspective, online abuse of women raises critical human rights concerns which certainly need to be addressed and resolved with maximum efficiency. Humanitarian NGOs such as Amnesty International have voiced their concerns about this topic and offered support.

A human right which some forms of TFGBV violate is the right to privacy. In some cases, through methods such as doxxing, sensitive imagery and information of survivors are used to facilitate the violence committed. In such cases privacy is ignored by the offenders. IBSA cases for instance are examples of acts of TFGBVs violating the right to privacy. With the Digital Age came generative AI technologies and further accessibility to such information, even through illegal means, which strengthened the offenders and made it much easier to gain leverage. Especially for generative AI, since it is a relatively new technology it can be used to abuse women much more easily.

The right to health can also be violated through Technology Facilitated Gender Based Violence. The right to health includes mental and physical health, which online harassment and abuse of women can damage. Some might believe that these can be avoided by reporting and blocking offenders in the spaces where digital violence occurs. Contrary to this belief, a considerable amount of times TFGBV exceeds these simple measures. Furthermore, in some instances such features don't even exist or are not done properly.

Technology Facilitated Gender Based Violence, although it begins in digital environments can very easily expand into the real world. Through sensitive information being acquired by abusers the possibilities of TFGBV affecting the lives of victims in the real world arise. Even though these actions start with verbal abuse and only digital interaction, it has been shown how easily it can escalate into paranoia, stalking and rape.

Human trafficking incidents also can be caused by Imagery Based Sexual Violence and TFGBV, being another way digital abuse of women can enter the physical dimension.

In cases of Technology Facilitated Gender Based Violence where blackmailing and IBSA are methods used by offenders the right to self-expression can be obstructed. In such scenarios bringing justice and punishment to offenders can be very difficult.

Forms of hate speech may also damage women's right to self expression in long term communities where it becomes normalized.

The right to self expression is a principle human right which should not be overlooked and deemed unimportant solely because it does not indicate physical damage being dealt to victims. Without self expression of women civil progression would be obstructed , crimes against women would be much harder to resolve.

TFGBV not only affects individuals who were directly targets of it but also families , communities and societies are negatively affected by this as well. Continuously marginalizing and attacking women, and this being normalized does not have good effects.

6.5 Judicial Dimension and Policy Recommendations

Effectively combatting Technology Facilitated Gender Based Violence requires innovative approaches, technical knowledge and full commitment. Those approaches should especially apply to judicial , legal advancements and policy discussions.

Legal developments and new policies regarding TFGBV need further definition and embodiment of human rights , meaning they should be strengthened while taking into account the need for effectiveness and the urgency. TFGBVs being systematic requires fast paced solution and decision making which current systems mostly lack.

Currently , legal systems detect each word of hatred and abuse as a different criminal offence. This approach ignores the damage which was caused by the accumulation of abuse instances. In this context , approaching situations focusing on the accumulation could make a difference for the better.

Legal responses should be accompanied by interconnected action between technology companies , states and communities to ensure survivors are protected and humanitarian rights such as the right to self expression are provided. Otherwise problems in the process will most likely be unavoidable.

For logical and effective decision making , technical knowledge can be necessary when dealing with cases of TFGBV. The providing of technical and informative assistance could build stronger decision making.

According to studies , the establishment of clear guidelines have had a positive impact on the amount of Technology Facilitated Gender Based Violence instances. Argentina has established such policies and have reported seeing positive results.

The handling of and the accountability of cases involving high profile people should also be addressed during policy talks. A primary example of such a case is the Epstein Island Case , which is detailed in further segments of the study guide and expanded upon the actions and policies which could be established to bring justice and prevent such circles from existing.

Lastly , underlining and reaffirming the importance of intergovernmental bodies and digital agreements such as the Global Digital Compact in tackling this growing issue. Improving and being in

co-operation with these frameworks and entities along with technology companies are needed for sustainable long term effective solution making.

7. Overview of the Case of Jeffery Epstein

First of all, let's start by clarifying the importance of evaluating this issue in the committee. The agenda is about violence against women in the digital age, what does it have to do with Epstein files? Why is it so crucial to discuss this very specific matter as UNWOMEN? Since we live in a digital age so assuming that most people have heard about Jeffery Epstein in the past or currently as over 3.5 million documents were released. So why is this the most important national problem for the United States and an international problem that international organisations such as the United Nations must take both judicial and humanitarian actions on? As we know from the past actions of Epstein, on his island or anywhere else bonding social networks with the most elite people from all around the world, he did not only make social networks or made financial investments, he did the most illegal things to humankind. From connecting with model agencies to dealing with political figures in order to sneak underage females from unstable areas or disasters. Now if we come to the specific point of the violation of women rights, most even all of his victims were underage female persons. Even though us, political figures, scientists, celebrities, presidents and most known names of the elite knew now and then; there were no solid judicial, humanitarian, legal or moral actions against these crimes. Because when it was asked to Epstein on his last trial "Why would you do this?" he cold bloodedly answered "No one stopped me, even some supported me." Now it is time for the UNWOMEN to take this matter on hand and come to a conclusion that will sustain justice.

Now let us wrap our heads around this matter. Jeffrey Epstein briefly transformed from being absolutely no one with no clear path nor education to being the biggest financial power with great connections and gained the "loyalty" of the elite. He amassed enormous wealth and elite access and relationships that placed him shoulder-to-shoulder with some of the most powerful and influential figures. According to the New York Times, Epstein made much of his fortune by providing tax and estate services to billionaires. He is friends with political figures such as Donald Trump, Bill Clinton, Prince Andrew the crown princess of Norway. Current files that were released by the House Democratic Caucus in September 2025 showed that he maintained his connections with billionaires such as Peter Teal, Elon Musk, Bill Gates and Larry Summers. Now we can see from his connections that very important intelligence agencies such as the Central Intelligence Agency (CIA) do not simply accumulate true information, they accumulate **leverage**. Now "leverage" is a very important key term here so here is the explanation: Leverage is influence, impact, power and a person's ability to affect others. Now leverage in politics may be both positive and negative. It can lead the person to positive access to capital, donors or elite networks. In other times; it is coercive, exploiting personal weaknesses, secrets and illegal behavior. When we take the matter of Epstein in hand, his leverage is mostly involved around sex trafficking. His aim was to maintain an environment for influential elites for them to indulge in desires that they could never safely pursue in public. And once leverage exists, control follows. For example, to mention his close friendship with Donald Trump in the 1990s; Trump's acquisition of the Miss Universe pageant placed hundreds of young, aspiring young women into his orbit.



In 2005, police in Palm Beach, Florida began investigating Epstein after a parent reported that he had sexually abused her 14 year old daughter. Federal officials identified 36 girls, some as young as 14 years old, whom Epstein allegedly sexually abused. Epstein pleaded guilty and was convicted in 2008 by a Florida state court of procuring a child for prostitution and soliciting a prostitute. He was convicted of only these two crimes as part of a controversial plea deal agreed by the U.S. Department of Justice's Alexander Acosta, and he served almost 13 months in custody but with extensive work release.

The 2008 plea deal involving Jeffrey Epstein raised major concerns about judicial violations and prosecutorial leverage. Federal prosecutors in the United States Department of Justice, led by U.S. Attorney Alexander Acosta, negotiated a Non-Prosecution Agreement (NPA) that allowed Epstein to plead guilty in state court to relatively minor charges of soliciting prostitution from a minor. In exchange, federal prosecutors agreed not to pursue federal sex-trafficking charges and granted immunity to several unnamed potential co-conspirators. Critics argued that this arrangement represented an unusual use of prosecutorial discretion that effectively shielded Epstein and others from more serious federal prosecution, despite substantial evidence gathered by federal investigations. The deal also raised allegations of procedural violations, particularly under the Crime Victims' Rights Act (CVRA), which requires prosecutors to notify victims and allow them to confer about major developments in a criminal case. Victims later argued that federal prosecutors secretly finalized the agreement without informing them, limiting their ability to challenge the outcome. These issues became central in later litigation, including the case of *Jane Doe v. United States* (Epstein CVRA litigation), where courts examined whether the government had violated victims' statutory rights. The controversy surrounding the plea agreement has since been cited in legal and policy debates as an example of how prosecutorial leverage and opaque plea bargaining can undermine transparency and victims' rights in the criminal justice system.

Recent releases of documents related to Jeffrey Epstein often referred to as the "Epstein files" have reignited international controversy and political tension. Millions of pages of documents, emails, flight logs, and investigative materials were made public under the Epstein Files Transparency Act, revealing details about Epstein's network and contacts among business leaders, celebrities, and political figures. By early 2026, the United States Department of Justice had released more than three million pages of material, including thousands of images and videos connected to the investigations. The documents reference numerous prominent individuals and have triggered investigations, resignations, and political debates in several countries about transparency and accountability. The releases have also intensified political tensions domestically and internationally because several high-profile figures and officials have appeared in communications or records linked to Epstein. Public scrutiny has fallen on political leaders, diplomats, and influential figures whose contact with Epstein is documented in emails or travel records, although inclusion in the files does not necessarily

imply criminal activity. For example, communications revealed interactions between Epstein and officials connected to governments in Europe and other regions, leading to political fallout and calls for investigations. In some cases, officials have resigned or faced parliamentary inquiries after their names appeared in correspondence with Epstein.

Another dimension of the controversy involves speculation and investigation regarding the potential involvement of intelligence agencies and international networks. Some documents contain references to geopolitical connections, meetings with foreign political figures, and financial or diplomatic contacts across multiple countries. Although many of these references remain unverified or inconclusive, they have fueled debates about whether Epstein's operations intersected with intelligence interests, international finance networks, or elite political circles. Such speculation has contributed to tensions between governments and public distrust toward institutions responsible for investigating and disclosing the full extent of Epstein's activities.



From a human rights perspective, the case represents a major failure to protect victims of sexual exploitation and trafficking. Epstein's criminal enterprise involved the recruitment, grooming, and abuse of minors over many years, highlighting systemic gaps in law enforcement, judicial oversight, and victim protection. Survivors and advocacy groups argue that delayed investigations, secrecy in legal processes, and the influence of powerful individuals contributed to prolonged injustice for victims. Because the case centers on gender-based violence, sexual exploitation,

and trafficking, international bodies such as UN Women have an important role to play in promoting accountability, supporting survivors, and strengthening global frameworks to combat exploitation and protect women and girls. Within a Model United Nations context, UN Women could lead initiatives to improve international cooperation on trafficking investigations, expand survivor support programs, and push for stronger transparency and human rights protections in cases involving powerful actors.

In order to gain high evidence you can reach the files and mails from this link of U.S. Department of Justice (DOJ) and Jmail:

<https://share.google/5uZei6w3328xEk0Y1> (PDF Files)

<https://share.google/mh4ov9A0Lfv6pEalj> (Mails)

8. The Epstein Files: What the Current Releases Reveal

Recent court document releases connected to the case of Jeffrey Epstein have intensified scrutiny of the handling of the investigation by the United States Department of Justice (DOJ) and other U.S. authorities. Many of these documents such as unsealed filings from lawsuits related to Epstein's associates and previously sealed investigative records have revealed additional information about his network, travel records, financial arrangements, and communications with influential individuals. The

background to these releases lies in years of legal challenges by journalists, victims, and advocacy groups who argued that the government maintained excessive secrecy around the investigation and prosecution of Epstein and his associates. Court orders in civil litigation, including cases connected to Epstein's associates, gradually forced the disclosure of previously sealed materials, leading to renewed public attention and debate. The tension between the public and the U.S. government largely stems from accusations that authorities failed to pursue the case with sufficient transparency and accountability. Critics argue that the DOJ's earlier handling of the investigation, particularly the controversial 2008 non-prosecution agreement negotiated by federal prosecutors, created the perception that Epstein received preferential treatment because of his wealth, social connections, and political influence. As additional court records emerged, many observers questioned why certain evidence had remained sealed for years and whether prosecutors had fully investigated all potential co-conspirators. These concerns have fueled political criticism in Congress and demands from civil society organizations for a more transparent review of prosecutorial decisions.

The broader controversy reflects growing distrust toward institutions responsible for investigating high-profile crimes involving powerful individuals. Survivors and advocacy groups have argued that the limited and gradual release of information delayed justice and prevented the public from understanding the full scope of Epstein's activities and connections. As new documents continue to be unsealed, the debate over transparency has become an important issue in legal and policy discussions, with critics calling for reforms that would ensure greater accountability, stronger victims' rights protections, and clearer oversight of prosecutorial discretion in cases involving elite networks and allegations of human trafficking.

Legal testimonies from survivors and witnesses have played a central role in revealing the scale and structure of the abuse network associated with Jeffrey Epstein. Many of these testimonies were collected through civil lawsuits, depositions, and criminal investigations beginning in the mid-2000s and continuing through the late 2010s. Several women stated under oath that they were recruited as teenagers and brought into Epstein's social circle through promises of financial help, employment, or educational opportunities. Testimonies frequently described a system in which young women were introduced to Epstein through intermediaries and then encouraged or pressured to recruit additional girls, creating what investigators and attorneys described as a structured pattern of exploitation. These accounts became a major element of later legal proceedings and civil settlements. A key figure repeatedly mentioned in legal testimonies is Ghislaine Maxwell, a longtime associate of Epstein. Multiple survivors alleged in court documents that Maxwell helped recruit and manage young women within Epstein's social environment, including arranging travel, introductions, and social meetings. Prosecutors later used these testimonies in criminal proceedings, arguing that Maxwell played an organizational role in facilitating abuse. In 2021, Maxwell was convicted in a United States federal court on charges related to sex trafficking and conspiracy, with several survivors providing testimony that contributed to the case. The legal proceedings highlighted how survivor statements, depositions, and documentary evidence can combine to reveal patterns of exploitation over long periods of time.

In addition to describing the recruitment methods and roles of individuals involved, legal testimonies also shed light on the broader social environment surrounding Epstein. Court filings referenced interactions with wealthy and influential figures, extensive travel, and properties in several countries, raising questions about how such activities continued for years without earlier legal intervention. Many survivors later stated that fear, power imbalances, and social pressure prevented them from reporting the abuse earlier. The release of various court documents and testimonies in recent years has therefore contributed to wider public debates about accountability, institutional failures, and the

challenges victims face when powerful individuals are involved. These testimonies remain central to understanding the humanitarian and justice-related dimensions of the case.

The allegations connected to Jeffrey Epstein had profound and long-lasting humanitarian consequences for survivors. Many individuals who provided testimony described experiencing severe psychological, emotional, and social impacts that extended far beyond the period in which the abuse occurred. Survivors of exploitation frequently report long-term trauma, including anxiety, depression, post-traumatic stress, and difficulties with trust and personal relationships. In cases involving minors and power imbalances, these effects can be even more severe, as young victims often face barriers to reporting abuse, including fear of retaliation, social stigma, or disbelief from authorities. From a humanitarian perspective, these harms highlight the broader societal responsibility to provide survivors with access to justice, psychological support, and safe reporting mechanisms.

From the perspective of UNWOMEN, such cases represent serious violations of internationally recognized human rights standards designed to protect women and girls from exploitation and violence. The exploitation described in legal proceedings contradicts the principles outlined in the Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination Against Women (CEDAW), which obligates states to prevent gender-based violence and ensure effective protection for women and girls. Additionally, the recruitment and abuse of minors violates international commitments established in the Convention on the Rights of the Child, which requires states to safeguard children from all forms of sexual exploitation and abuse. These frameworks emphasize that governments and institutions share responsibility for preventing exploitation and ensuring accountability when violations occur.

The humanitarian dimension of these cases also highlights systemic challenges in achieving justice for survivors. When abuse involves individuals with significant economic, political, or social influence, survivors may face additional barriers such as intimidation, legal complexity, or delayed investigations. From a global policy perspective, this raises concerns about institutional failures in protecting vulnerable individuals and enforcing legal accountability. Organizations within the United Nations system, including UNWOMEN, stress that addressing these failures requires stronger survivor-centered legal frameworks, greater transparency in investigations, and international cooperation to prevent exploitation networks from operating across borders.

In response to the global rise in gender-based violence and exploitation, the United Nations has adopted several resolutions emphasizing the protection of women and girls and the importance of accountability. For example, the UN General Assembly Resolution 48/104 – Declaration on the Elimination of Violence Against Women recognizes violence against women as a violation of fundamental human rights and calls on states to take comprehensive measures to prevent, investigate, and punish such acts. The humanitarian lessons drawn from high-profile cases underscore the importance of these commitments and reinforce the role of international institutions in strengthening protections, supporting survivors, and promoting justice in cases of gender-based exploitation.

The legal proceedings surrounding Jeffrey Epstein have raised significant judicial questions regarding accountability, transparency, and the effectiveness of legal systems when confronting crimes involving influential individuals. One major point of controversy was the 2008 plea agreement reached with federal prosecutors, which allowed Epstein to plead guilty to lesser charges in state court rather than face more serious federal prosecution. Critics argued that the agreement limited the scope of investigations and prevented potential co-conspirators from being fully examined in court. The case later returned to national attention when federal authorities arrested Epstein again in 2019,

demonstrating the importance of continued judicial review and the reopening of investigations when new evidence emerges. From a legal perspective, this situation illustrates the need for stronger oversight mechanisms to ensure that prosecutorial decisions remain transparent and consistent with principles of justice.

The United States government holds a primary responsibility to ensure that investigations related to such cases remain comprehensive, impartial, and survivor-centered. This includes fully examining evidence contained in court records, testimonies, and related documents, as well as ensuring that all individuals potentially involved in illegal activities are subject to appropriate legal scrutiny. Judicial transparency, protection of witnesses, and access to legal remedies for survivors are essential components of restoring trust in the justice system. Additionally, strengthening laws related to trafficking, exploitation, and conspiracy could help prevent similar situations from occurring in the future. Ensuring that legal institutions operate independently from political or social influence is also critical in maintaining accountability in high-profile cases.

Because the allegations and activities linked to Epstein involved international travel and contacts across multiple jurisdictions, cooperation between the United States and other states is also essential. Governments whose territories, financial institutions, or transportation networks may have been connected to these activities have a responsibility to support investigations through evidence sharing, legal assistance, and coordinated law enforcement efforts. International cooperation mechanisms—such as mutual legal assistance treaties and cross-border judicial investigations—can help ensure that crimes involving exploitation networks are addressed comprehensively. Strengthening such cooperation reflects broader global commitments to combating human trafficking, protecting vulnerable individuals, and upholding international human rights standards.

9. Questions to be Answered

1. How can Member States strengthen legislation to prevent and address technology-facilitated gender-based violence (TFGBV)?
2. What measures should governments implement to improve the safety of women and girls in digital spaces, including social media platforms?
3. How can international organizations such as UN Women support Member States in combating online harassment, cyberbullying, and digital exploitation?
4. What responsibilities should technology companies and digital platforms hold in preventing online abuse, exploitation, and gendered hate speech?
5. How can governments ensure that victims and survivors of digital violence have access to legal protection, psychological support, and safe reporting mechanisms?
6. What legal frameworks can be strengthened to ensure accountability in cases involving powerful individuals or organized exploitation networks?
7. How can judicial systems improve transparency and fairness when investigating high-profile cases such as those associated with Jeffrey Epstein?
8. What international mechanisms can be created or strengthened to facilitate cross-border investigations and cooperation in cases of exploitation and trafficking?

9. How can governments balance public transparency and the protection of survivors' privacy when releasing court documents and legal evidence?
10. What steps can be taken to prevent institutional failures that allow exploitation networks to operate undetected for long periods?
11. How can education systems and public awareness campaigns help reduce gender-based harassment and exploitation in digital environments?
12. What policies can ensure stronger protection for whistleblowers, journalists, and investigators exposing gender-based exploitation networks?
13. How can the international community strengthen the implementation of frameworks such as the Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination Against Women in addressing modern digital forms of violence?
14. What humanitarian support systems should be developed to assist survivors of exploitation and abuse, particularly in cases with international dimensions?
15. How can Member States ensure long-term accountability and justice for survivors in cases where investigations span multiple countries and jurisdictions?